

SERVERLESS COMPUTING: REDUCING INFRASTRUCTURE MANAGEMENT IN THE CLOUD

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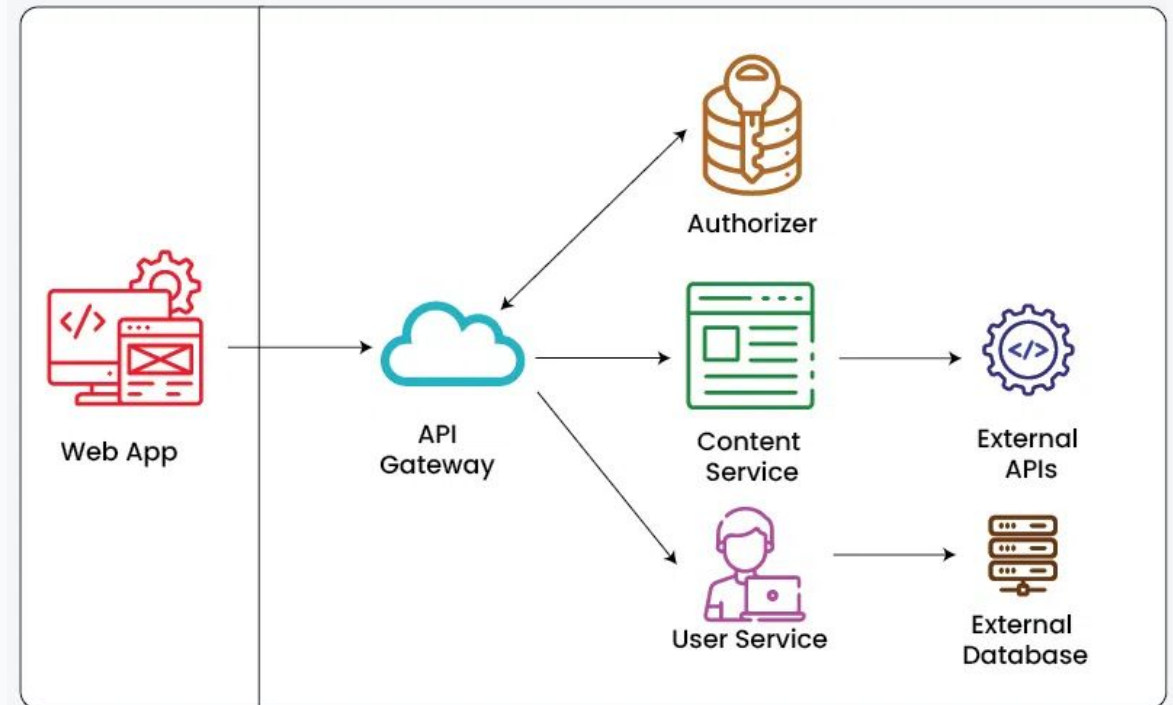
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Core of Serverless: FaaS

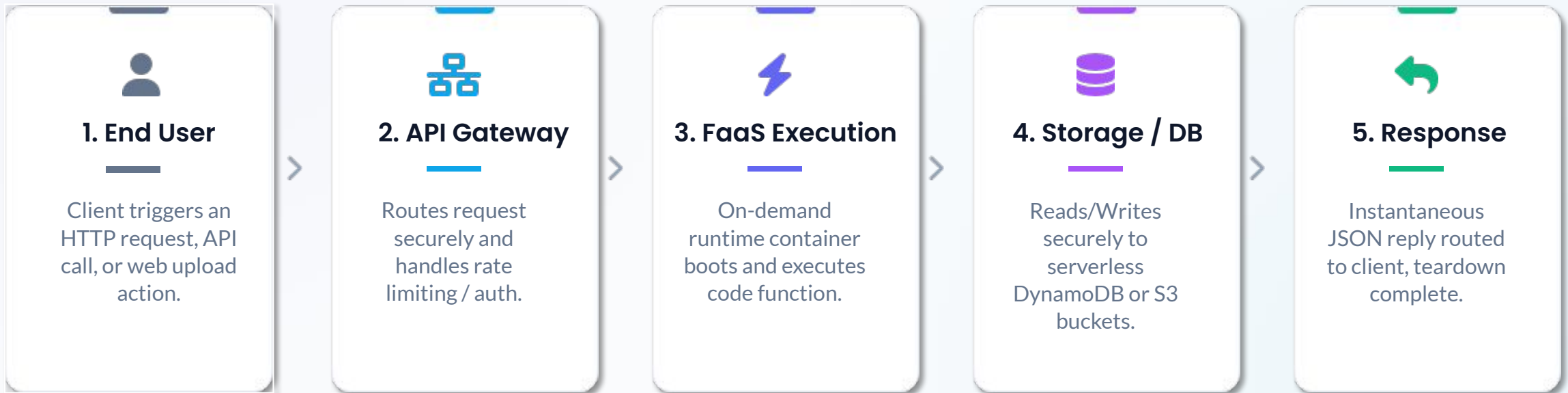
Function-as-a-Service

- FaaS is the central developer interface of serverless systems, shifting focusing purely to modular execution units.
- Developers deploy lightweight stateless functions triggered dynamically by webhooks, events, or messaging queues.
- The system guarantees automatic scale-to-zero capability when dormant, fully automating standard operational management.

What is Function as a Service (FaaS)



The Serverless Workflow



Key Business Advantages



Zero Idle Cost

No active host server bills when idle. Only pay for execution time measured precisely to the millisecond.



Infinite Scalability

The platform inherently replicates runtimes from 1 to 100k instances automatically on traffic surges.



Faster Delivery

Eliminating system patching, OS upgrades, and VM configurations dramatically speeds up product ship times.

Practical Use Cases



REST APIs & Web Apps

Powering dynamic backends via simple API endpoints. Runtimes remain completely quiescent until queried by active clients.



Image & Media Processing

Triggering automatic resized optimization or video transcodes immediately upon file uploads to cloud object storage.



Chatbots & IoT Ingestion

Processing millions of brief sensor telemetry signals dynamically. Idle endpoints require zero pre-provisioned infrastructure.



Real-time Data Pipelines

Streaming data transformations, log parsing engines, and immediate ETL procedures executing asynchronously on incoming records.

Serverless Engineering Challenges

- **Cold Start Latency:**

The inevitable micro-delay when a container instance spin-up occurs following period of inactivity.

- **Maximum Timeout Restrictions:**

Most common serverless providers strictly limit process lifetimes (typically 15 minutes max per invocation).

- **Vendor Lock-In:**

Code structures can easily become tightly bound to specialized proprietary APIs of individual vendors.



Serverless Platform Comparison

Specification	AWS Lambda	Azure Functions	Google Cloud Functions
Max Timeout	15 Minutes	10 Minutes (Cons. Plan)	60 Minutes (HTTP)
Native Runtimes	Node.js Python Java Go	C# Node.js Python Java	Node.js Python Go Java
Scaling Speed	Immediate, highly concurrent	Dynamic based on events	Rapid, near instantaneous
Free Tier Allowance	1 Million requests/mo	1 Million requests/mo	2 Million requests/mo

The Future of Cloud Development

Focus Shifts to Value

- ⇒ Developers construct customer features directly instead of managing operating system patches.

Maximized Resource Efficiency

- ⇒ Eliminates active cloud bill overhead when systems sit completely idle.

Serverless Ecosystem Growth

- ⇒ Expanding fast with serverless containers, databases, and message brokers globally.



Join the Shift

Serverless computing isn't just about deleting servers. It's about maximizing software velocity.